

Educational Kits: Innovation Lacking, Sales Thriving

The educational kits industry in India is expected to grow 30-35 per cent annually till year 2018 with the launch of National Skill Development Mission by the government. The focus of this mission is skills development by having more institutes, revising the syllabus and converting the existing institutes into centres of excellence, which will drive the demand for educational kits



ThinnkWare's robot kit

UMA GUPTA

In the last few years, the educational kits industry in India has evolved at a rapid pace. A lot of players have entered the market with a wide range of kits. Almost all the players are doing brisk business, although the industry is still struggling with inadequate infrastructure to support low-volume educational kits manufacture.

Future depends upon the innovation that the companies will offer. Simply importing from China or somewhere else is not going to work. We need good content that tells customers how to use kits and application notes built around kits to give them maximum advantage—according to V.V. Pathy Iyer, business development manager—Education,

Electronics Measurement Group, Agilent Technologies India.

The market is huge due to its relevance at various levels of study. The future outlook too looks very bright, given the investments and the mindshare for education growth in the country. We have many more engineering colleges coming up every year. Also, the existing tier 2 and tier 3 markets have not been tapped completely.

Paras Dagli, proprietor, Kenkraft, expects the educational kits industry to

register an annual growth rate of 30-35 per cent till year 2018 with the launch of National Skills Development Mission.

“Currently, there is a huge industry-academia gap. The issue has been taken up by FICCI, CII and other such bodies. The focus of the national mission is skills development by having more institutes, revising the syllabus and converting the existing institutes into centres of excellence,” Dagli adds.

Technological trends

The technological trends witnessed in educational kits are no different from technological advancements.

“The new kits are compact, easy-to-use, fast, intuitive and interesting. This is made possible by the continued technology advancement in smaller, faster, cheaper electronics and easier access to software applications,” shares Pathy Iyer.

“Earlier, lab kits were very costly. Now the cost has gone down steeply. Low-cost 8-/32-bit microcontroller kits are available. Future belongs to targeted DIY kits that are designed to solve particular problems. Although we do not have very good Open Source hardware platform currently originating from India, we are hopeful that in

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